

Type sets the tone.

Typography Systems

Two studies in hierarchy, composition
and editorial rhythm.

GD 232 · DePaul University
Spring 2026 · Academic work

ONE-X

A Typography Study of
3 Days Grace

Designed by
Andrew Dumitru

GD 232 Typography: Systems
DePaul University
Spring 2026

One discipline. Two ways to explore it.

STUDY 01

Hierarchy through variation

The lecture-series layouts reuse the same information while changing scale, alignment, orientation and emphasis. Repetition makes the differences in reading order visible.

STUDY 02

An editorial identity

ONE-X applies a more consistent visual language to a music publication: member profiles, song spreads and an album timeline. Variation happens within a shared system.

THE DESIGN QUESTION

How can typography establish a clear reading order while giving each composition its own character?

Same content. Different reading paths.

Selected compositions from Book 1

DePartment of Arthitecture | The University of Tokyo

Sekisui House
Kuma Lab Lecture Series

SEKISUI HOUSE – KUMA LAB is a new platform for the development of international human resources in the field of architecture. It will be equipped with digital fabrication facilities open to the campus and an archive of digitized valuable materials from the Department of Architecture.

This environment will be used to offer a new design studio program led by the world's leading architects, and to provide access to materials for researchers inside and outside the university. We hope that it will become a place where experts from various fields can gather to discuss the future of housing.

Hosoo Masataka
“Creative Dialogue with Traditional Crafts”
Wednesday, May 22th, 2024 , 18:30 - 22:00

Mireia Luzárraga
“Becoming Postnatural”
Monday April 8th, 2024. 19:00 – 20:30 JST

Philip Ursprung
“Neighbours: The Swiss Pavilion at the Venice Architecture Biennale”
Tuesday, November 17th, 2023, 18:00 – 19:30

Jesse Reiser, Nanako Umemoto
“Dawning Animisms”
Monday, October 16th, 2023, 19:00 - 20:30

Florian Idenburg
“In Real Life”
Friday October 13th, 2023, 18:00 –19:30

Place : **HASEKO KUMA HALL**, Engineering Building no.11, 7-3-1, Hongo, Bunkyo-ku, Tokyo
Language : **English**
No registration required. Please directly come to the venue

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Sekisui House Kuma Lab Lecture Series

DePartment
of
Arthitecture

The University of Tokyo

01

A steady entry

A horizontal title and aligned text establish a predictable top-to-bottom sequence.

02

Direction as emphasis

Rotated information introduces a second reading direction and a more active composition.

03

Space as structure

Separated groups give the title, programme and supporting details their own positions.

Changing emphasis changes the page.

Color fields and typographic contrast create alternate centres of attention.

*De*partment of *Ar*thitecture

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OBSERVATION

Two different kinds of contrast

The blue composition uses light and yellow type against a saturated field. The adjacent layout keeps a white ground and gathers the programme inside a pale block.

TRADE-OFF

Expression versus ease

Rotated text and multiple emphasis styles give the spread energy, but ask readers to switch direction and interpret more competing signals.

A voice that carries across the publication.

Black, warm paper and burgundy form the recurring palette. Large serif titles and pale oversized numerals create a recognisable visual rhythm.

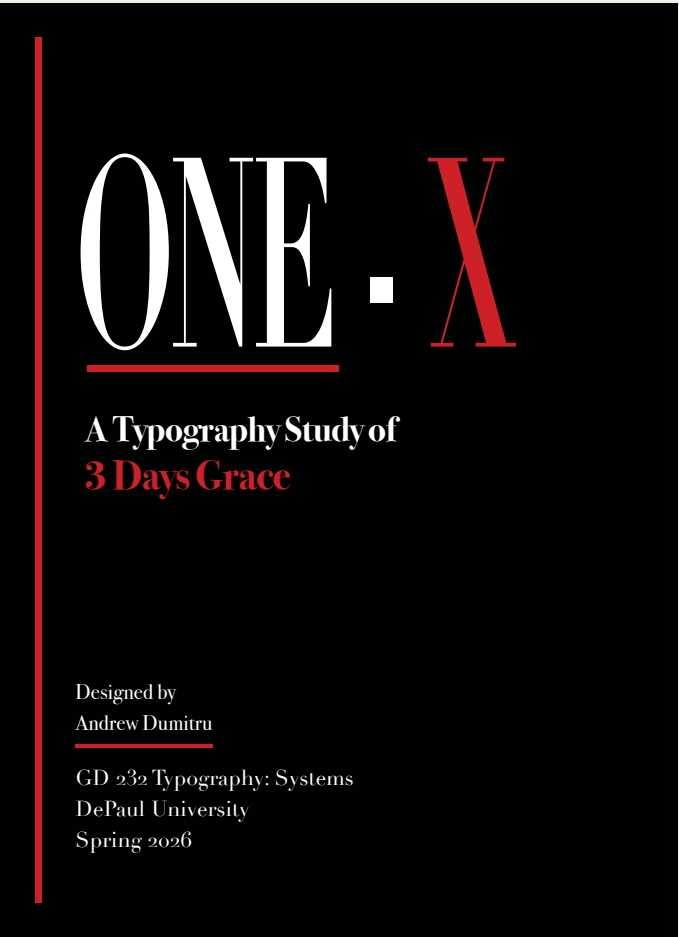
IDENTITY

Recurring elements, varied layouts

The cover establishes the title treatment and red rule. Interior pages repeat those cues while changing density, image placement and orientation.

TYPE IN THE DOCUMENT

Didot · Bodoni 72 · Minion Pro

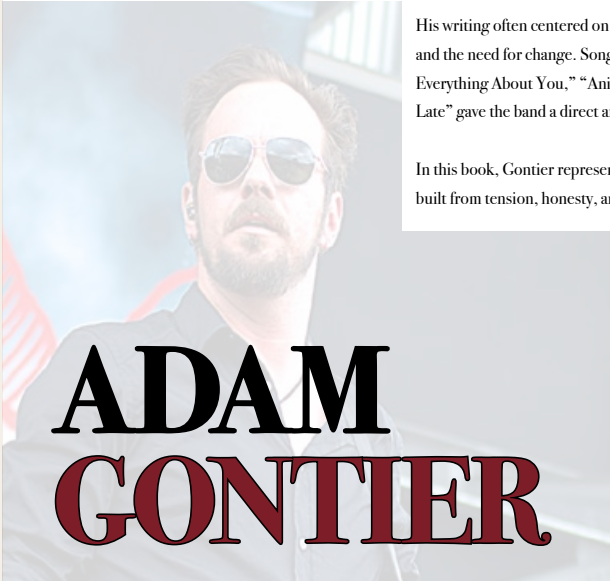


The name becomes the anchor.

A horizontal name treatment and a vertical one create contrasting entry points.

PART 2: THE MEMBERS

05



ADAM GONTIER

MEMBER ONE

Adam Gontier was one of the defining voices of Three Days Grace. As the band's original lead vocalist, guitarist, and principal songwriter, he helped shape the emotional intensity that made the group widely recognizable.

His writing often centered on alienation, anger, addiction, recovery, and the need for change. Songs such as "I Hate Everything About You," "Animal I Have Become," and "Never Too Late" gave the band a direct and deeply personal voice.

In this book, Gontier represents the band's emotional core: a lyric voice built from tension, honesty, and release.

BORN: May 25, 1978

ORIGIN: Peterborough, Ontario, Canada

KNOWN FOR: Original frontman of Three Days Grace

KEY ALBUMS: *Three Days Grace*, *One-X*, *Life Starts Now*

A voice built from tension, honesty, and release

PART 2: THE MEMBERS

06



BARRY STOCK

MEMBER TWO

LEAD GUITAR

Barry Stock is the lead guitarist of Three Days Grace. He joined the band in 2003, shortly after the release of their self-titled debut album, expanding the group's sound into a four-piece structure.

His guitar work supports the band's heavy, melodic, and emotionally direct identity. Rather than overwhelming the songs, Stock's playing adds weight, texture, and atmosphere around the vocal line.

Across albums such as *One-X*, *Life Starts Now*, *Transit of Venus*, *Human*, *Outsider*, *Explosions*, and *Alienation*, Stock has remained a steady force in the band's evolution.

BORN: April 24, 1974

ORIGIN: Belgium / Canada-based musician

ROLE: Lead guitarist

KNOWN FOR: Heavy riffs, melodic leads, atmospheric guitar work

KEY ALBUMS: *One-X*, *Life Starts Now*, *Transit of Venus*, *Human*

I write from feeling, not for attention.

SCALE

Names dominate before body copy.

REPETITION

Rules and large numerals link the pages.

BALANCE

Portraits offset compact text columns.

Build rhythm through contrast.

PART 2: THE MEMBERS

07

**BRAD
WALST**

MEMBER THREE

Brad Walst is a founding member of Three Days Grace and one of the band's longest-standing voices. As bassist and backing vocalist, he gives the music its low-end weight and steady forward motion.

His playing is direct, forceful, and rhythmic, helping the band balance heaviness with clarity. Walst's presence is often felt less through spotlight and more through structure: the part of the sound that holds everything together.

In this book, Walst represents foundation, movement, and pressure the pulse beneath the songs.

BORN: February 17, 1977

ORIGIN: Norwood / Ontario

ERA: Founding Member

ROLE: Bassist, Backing Vocals

KNOWN FOR: Driving bass lines and rhythmic force

KEY ALBUMS: Three Days Grace, One-X, Life Starts Now, Outsider



PART 2: THE MEMBERS

08

foundation,
movement,
and pressure

MEMBER 04

**NEIL
SANDERSON**

DRUMS · BACKING VOCALS



Pulse
Control
and
Impact

Neil Sanderson is a founding member of Three Days Grace and one of the band's key musical anchors. As drummer, backing vocalist, and songwriter, he helps shape the group's rhythm, intensity, and emotional drive.

His role extends beyond percussion. Sanderson supports the band's architecture through timing, arrangement, and layered vocal presence, giving the songs both momentum and depth.

In this book, Sanderson represents pulse, control, and impact the force that pushes the music forward.

BORN: February 17, 1977

ORIGIN: Norwood / Ontario

ERA: Founding Member

ROLE: Drums, Backing Vocals, Songwriter

KNOWN FOR: Rhythmic drive, arrangement, and vocal support

KEY ALBUMS: Three Days Grace, One-X, Life Starts Now, Transit of Venus

COMPOSITION

Variation within the system

Member spreads alternate image position, title placement and the density of text. Burgundy accents and serif typography keep those changes connected.

READING EXPERIENCE

Give the eye a reset

Large numerals, white space and short accent passages interrupt denser columns. Their visual role is to create a pause and a new point of entry.

Selected member-profile spread from ONE-X.

Small decisions, repeated deliberately.

INTRODUCTION

Three Days Grace is a Canadian rock band from Norwood, Ontario, first formed in the early 1990s under the name Groundswell before regrouping under its current name in 1997. Their music grew out of post grunge and hard rock, combining heavy guitar structure with direct emotional language.

The band’s work often centers on conflict, isolation, pain, survival, and the pressure of change. Songs such as “I Hate Everything About You,” “Animal I Have Become,” “Pain,” and “Never Too Late” use plainspoken lyrics and intense repetition to make emotional struggle feel immediate.

Through type alone, the spirit of Three Days Grace is presented as a system of pressure and release: **Dark, Direct, and Emotionally controlled.**

04

THE
SOUND
OF
THREE
DAYS
GRACE

—

A BAND THAT GAVE VOICE TO
FRUSTRATION, PAIN, AND THE
SEARCH FOR SOMETHING MORE.

Three Days Grace built a sound that speaks the language of real life. It is heavy without becoming chaotic. It is emotional without apology. It connects because it is direct.

Their songs move between quiet moments of doubt and explosive outbursts of anger. This contrast exists not only in the music, but also in the words. The band writes about what people often feel but rarely say out loud: failure, rejection, self-hate, pressure, and the need for change.

The following pages explore the people, lyrics, and albums that define Three Days Grace. Through type alone, this book captures the spirit of a band whose voice continues to resonate. Three Days Grace built a sound that speaks the language of real life. It is heavy without becoming chaotic. It is emotional without apology. It connects because it is direct.

HIERARCHY

Separate levels of information

A large title, restrained section label and smaller body copy establish distinct roles. Rules add structure without enclosing every element in a box.

CONSISTENCY

Repeat the visual vocabulary

Pale numbers, burgundy markers and serif headlines recur across different page types. A recognisable system allows the composition to change.

10

THE
FIVE
VOICES

A system of pressure, rhythm, and release.

Three Days Grace is built from distinct roles that work together as one system. Voices, rhythm, lead, bass, and percussion create the balance of weight, tension, and momentum that defines the band’s sound. This page closes the member section by presenting the lineup as a unified structure rather than five isolated parts.

PART 2: THE MEMBERS

01

ADAM GONTIER
Lead Vocals / Guitar

02

MATT WALST
Lead Vocals

03

BARRY STOCK
Lead Guitar

04

BRAD WALST
Bass / Backing Vocals

05

NEIL SANDERSON
Drums / Backing Vocals

A system should hold together. A page should still surprise.

WHAT THE WORK SHOWS

Hierarchy is more than size

Position, alignment, grouping, orientation and empty space all change which information is encountered first. The lecture studies make those choices directly comparable.

WHAT THE WORK SHOWS

Consistency permits variation

ONE-X has a stronger shared identity because its palette and recurring typographic elements persist even when a spread changes direction or density.

NEXT REFINEMENT

Strengthen portrait contrast, simplify outlined name treatments, and check body copy at intended print size. Compare reading order with readers before claiming a readability improvement.